

Why is Big Data So Important for Enterprises?

In today's world, there is an explosion of data from social media and other sources. Enterprises carefully harvest this data and store it for meaningful reuse. Handling such vast quantities of data requires specialised tools and techniques. Big Data is here to stay as an important part of our lives.



Currently, logging in to our Facebook account, uploading pictures on Instagram or taking a peek at the various products on Flipkart, Amazon or Snapdeal has become part of our daily routine. We feel the day is incomplete when we don't see our messages on Whatsapp. The tech savvy world is being ruled by online social media like FB, Whatsapp, Twitter, etc. So have you ever given a thought to the peta and exabytes of data being generated daily by social media or various enterprise applications? According to Wikipedia, 2.5 exabytes of data are created every day by various online apps. It becomes quite difficult to manage and play around with such a large amount of data.

Big Data, as the name itself suggests, refers to the huge amounts of data that are difficult to capture, manage or process, even with the help of various software tools. Big

Data requires the use of various techniques and technologies such as predictive user behaviour or other advanced data analytics to obtain useful insights from them, which can be leveraged further. According to Wikipedia, Big Data is a term for data sets that are so large or complex that traditional data processing applications are inadequate. It needs to be acquired, organised and analysed computationally to identify certain patterns or trends that further facilitate the processing, updating or management of such huge amounts of data.

The five Vs of Big Data

We can identify Big Data with the help of the following characteristics:

1. **Volume:** Big Data is characterised largely on the basis of the quantity of generated and stored data.